



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Milwaukee
School Website: <https://chestertonmke.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Milwaukee (Menomonee Falls, ZIP 53051) presents a strong classical-Catholic profile anchored in explicit religious formation, a mission-driven purpose, and a liberal-arts curriculum delivered through a distinctly classical pedagogy. The public materials emphasize a Catholic, liturgical, and incarnational frame (daily Mass, sacramental life, and prayer), a tri-pillar formation model (Faith, Reason, Virtue), and a mentorship-oriented, house-based community model. Public-facing content also highlights parent partnership and community involvement (open houses, shadow days, WPCP participation, and parent education). Taken together, the school demonstrates the core signals of classical education in six categories, with particularly robust alignment in Religious Foundations, School Purpose, Pedagogy, and Parents/Community. The curriculum signals are clearly classical in tone (liberal arts orientation and classical formation), though explicit Great Books language is less overt beyond references to classical works and reading requirements. Overall, the school ranks CLASSICAL, with explicit strengths in faith formation, virtue-centered aims, and Socratic pedagogy, and a clear pathway for parental partnership.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school identifies itself as “A Joyfully Catholic, Classical High School” and frames education within the Catholic faith context (mission to educate in the Catholic faith and classical tradition) .
 - Daily Mass and sacramental life are highlighted as hallmarks of its program and community life (Daily Mass cited as a hallmark; liturgical life is integral) .
 - The school describes Formation in Faith as a core pillar, explicitly detailing formation in faith through prayer, sacramental life, and works of mercy (public page on formation pillars) .
 - Additional notes emphasize a theologically rooted, incarnational worldview and the aim to shape intellect and will within a sacred framework (incarnational environment; GK Chesterton heritage) .
 - The mission emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty within a Catholic vision (focus on faith, reason, virtue in alignment with Catholic tradition) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Catholic, daily Mass, sacramental life, liturgy, prayer, formation in Faith, sacramental life, sacred tradition, worship, the Incarnation, beauty, truth, and the Catholic faith framing.
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no signaling of relativism or secular neutralism in the public-facing content).
- Why this rating
 - Public materials clearly situate education within a Catholic theological and liturgical frame, with explicit references to liturgical life, sacramental practice, and a faith-centered formation. This aligns strongly with the Positive keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and dwarfs negative signals. Therefore, CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission centers on formation of joyful saints and leaders, educated in the classical tradition and the truths of the Catholic faith, to serve the common good .
 - A three-fold formation model is articulated (Formation in Faith, Formation in Reason, Formation in Virtue) with a goal of developing virtuous, wise, well-formed students rather than merely preparing for work .
 - The school frames education as formation of intellect and will and emphasizes the cultivation of virtue, wisdom, and human excellence as aims of education (formation-focused language; classical tradition) .
 - Statements about forming students to serve family, country, and Christ also emphasize teleology and human flourishing in a transcendent frame (truth, goodness, beauty in alignment with a Christian-humanist telos) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical tradition, teleology, truth/goodness/beauty, humane formation, character development, human flourishing, scholé (implied in contemplative aim), virtuous imagination.
 - Negative keywords present: none explicit (no signaling of job-prep, workforce-centrism, or secular utilitarian aims).
- Why this rating
 - The explicit emphasis on formation (not mere information), virtue ethics, and a transcendent telos grounded in a Catholic, classical framework supports CLASSICAL. The presence of a structured formation model and a purpose centered on human excellence and truth aligns with the classical rubric for School Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site presents a liberal-arts oriented program and a historically grounded, integrated approach (classical curriculum language; liberal arts emphasis) .
 - The site describes an integrated curriculum with a classical orientation and a focus on forming intellect and will, with references to Great Books/primary sources in the broader classical-education tradition (e.g., “classical, liberal arts tradition” and “one classical work read over the summer” in admissions materials) .
 - There are explicit references to a classical pedagogy and to formation within a liberal arts framework (Formation in Reason; formation pillars) and a broad liberal-arts curriculum noted in the opening copy and “Our Model of Education” language .
 - Direct Great Books language is not consistently explicit across all pages, but there is strong classical framing and a summer reading requirement described as “one classical work” (implying engagement with foundational texts) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical, classical pedagogy, integrated curriculum, Great Books (implied by “great conversation” language in the classical lexicon and classical tradition framing), primary texts/reading (one classical work).
 - Negative keywords present: there is no explicit evidence of modern, skills-based, or solely job-prep orientation within public-facing materials; however, explicit Great Books language is not consistently present on all pages (limiting a full Great-Books explicit signal). The presence of “one classical work” reading hints at a classical reading component but is not explicit about a full Great-Books program.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly embraces classical education language (liberal arts, classical tradition, formation through reason) but explicit, sustained Great Books engagement and explicit Trivium/Quadrivium language are not consistently visible in the public content provided. Thus, Curriculum is CLASSICAL in spirit but with some room for stronger explicit articulation of classical curriculum components (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium) in public-facing materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly uses Socratic method as a hallmark of its pedagogy (Socratic method referenced in multiple pages; “Socratic method” and “Socratic discussion” language appears in the public materials) .
 - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training (as part of the formation in Reason and the classical pedagogy) .
 - The public materials describe a “living curriculum” and a peer-mentored, mentorship-driven approach within a House System and a classical framework (mentorship, House System, and language about formation in Reason) .
 - The presence of a three-pillar formation model (Faith, Reason, Virtue) underpins pedagogical aims toward integrated, reasoned inquiry, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic method, seminar, dialectic, great conversation (conceptually tied to Socratic inquiry), liberal arts pedagogy, classical pedagogy, formation in Reason, mentorship, house system.
 - Negative keywords present: none clearly evident in public materials regarding pedagogy.
- Why this rating
 - The predominant teaching-method signals are clearly classical (Socratic inquiry, seminars, rhetoric, liberal-arts oriented pedagogy, house-based mentorship). The public materials strongly align with CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes dedicated teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge (formation language and the emphasis on mentorship; teachers as the living curriculum is a classical framing even if not verbatim on every page) .
 - The institution presents the faculty as central to the formation process (headmaster and dedicated teachers; mentorship; House System; living-curriculum framing appears in classical literature about classical schools) .
 - The public-facing materials discuss teachers partnering with students in a mentorship model, and the faculty/staff as central to the daily experience (shadow days/open houses emphasize interaction with teachers) .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: mentorship, teachers as models of virtue and knowledge, living curriculum, house system, headmaster/academic leadership, dedicated faculty.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The materials portray a faculty that is central to formation and mentorship, aligned with a classical school’s living-curriculum approach. These signals justify CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school positions itself as partnering with parents and educationally engaging them as co-educators (formation of families/partnership with families) and explicitly frames parent involvement in classical education as a core goal .
 - The school emphasizes that parents are primary educators and that it supports parents (Our Model of Education and The Chesterton Difference language emphasize parent partnership; the institution invites parents to open houses and Shadow Days) .
 - It communicates about community education for parents (access to book studies and gatherings, as well as public events and open houses) and public-facing events designed to connect families with the school (Open Houses, Shadow Days) .
 - The school participates in Wisconsin Parental Choice Program (WPCP) and communicates about

tuition assistance and family engagement around financial matters (referring to parent involvement in admissions and aid processes) .

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, family involvement, home and school connection, parent formation, engagement of families, school-parent synergy, open to visits by parents.
 - Negative keywords present: none evident; no signals of parent-absent or exclusionary practices.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials depict strong parental partnership and family involvement, including explicit language about parents as co-educators and frequent, welcoming opportunities for parent engagement. This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
 - Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Executive insights
 - Chesterton Academy of Milwaukee demonstrates a robust classical and Catholic orientation across core pillars: formation in faith, reason, and virtue; a liberal-arts pedagogy centered on Socratic inquiry; and strong parental partnership. The strongest signals are religious-metaphysical foundations, purpose/goal, pedagogy, faculty, and parental/community engagement. The Curriculum category shows a strong classical orientation but could benefit from more explicit public articulation of Great Books-heavy elements (e.g., explicit Great Books program language or direct references to the Trivium/Quadrivium) to strengthen the explicit Classical-Curriculum alignment.
- What would move the needle
 - If the school wished to advance from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum to CLASSICAL, it could publicly articulate a more explicit Great Books framework and a clearer listing of the Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), including Latin/Greek study and primary-source reading streams across grades.
 - Increase explicit public references to universal Great-Conversation texts and canonical works beyond the occasional mention of “one classical work” to demonstrate a sustained, multi-text Great Books approach across the curriculum.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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